officers about their own clerks.[133] Why rowdies would want to stop people from buying European products is not clear. What a weak inspector could contribute to the Swadeshi cause is a moot question. The tide had turned in favour of SSNCo following the arrival of the *Gallia* and the *Lawoe*.

In this context, there were daily altercations and skirmishes. The resolution of these issues on the ground was far from lasting. The administration prohibited the selling of tickets on the streets and the touting of passengers.[134] Consequently, the rival companies had to establish proper booking offices. But when SSNCo opened a booking office in an eating house opposite the railway station on 29 August, the local inspector objected on the ground that this had caused friction earlier and had been prohibited. The Swadeshi company, on its part, claimed to have the verbal permission of the district collector. The inspector applied to the sub-magistrate for orders under Section 144 of the Criminal Procedure Code and issued a notice apprehending a breach of peace if BI too were to open a booking office nearby. The notice was stalled for a while as Somasundara Bharati, SSNCo's manager—who, we will recall, was also a lawyer—was not in town.[135] Finally, the issue was resolved in favour of the Swadeshi company. The district collector, explaining his stand internally, confirmed this: there was 'no means of prohibiting [it] and it was best to graciously assent'. 'If the BI was to start a rival depot and a breach of peace was likely', he assured his superiors 'both parties will be bound over'.[136]

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Despite the heavy odds, SSNCo performed creditably in 1907–08: the *Gallia* made nineteen voyages carrying 1,952 passengers while the *Lawoe* completed ninety-five voyages carrying 10,652½ passengers (Table 4.1).[137] The entries in *Daily Index and Weekly Index to Lloyd's List*, 1907–11 lists only sixteen voyages recorded for the *Gallia* between April and September; as for the *Lawoe*, thirty-four voyages are recorded between June and December 1907 and nineteen between January and March 1908 (see Tables 4.2; 4.3). Evidently, the Lloyd's Register was far from being perfect and the